

Power BI 150 **Q&A Cheat** **Sheet for** **Interview** **Preparation**

www.powerbidocs.com/ Insta: @powerbitutorials/ LinkedIn: sandeeptraturi



SECTION 1: POWER BI BASICS

1. What is Power BI?

Power BI is a business analytics tool by Microsoft for visualizing data and sharing insights.

2. What are the components of Power BI?

Power BI Desktop, Power BI Service, Power BI Mobile, Power BI Gateway, and Power BI Report Builder.

3. What is Power BI Desktop used for?

To create and design reports locally on your computer.

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4. What is Power BI Service?

An online SaaS platform (app.powerbi.com) for publishing, sharing, and collaborating on reports.

5. What is Power BI Gateway?

A connector that allows on-premises data to refresh in the Power BI Service.

6. What is a Dataset?

A dataset is a collection of data used to create reports in Power BI.

7. What is a Report?

A report is a multi-page visualization created using Power BI Desktop.

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8. What is a Dashboard?

A single-page summary of visuals pinned from different reports.

9. What are the data connectivity modes in Power BI?

Import, DirectQuery, and Live Connection.

10. Difference between Import and DirectQuery?

Import stores data in Power BI; DirectQuery queries the source in real-time.

11. What is a Workspace?

A shared area in Power BI Service to manage reports, dashboards, and datasets.

12. What is Power BI App?

A packaged collection of dashboards and reports shared with end users.

13. What is Power BI Pro?

A license allowing collaboration, sharing, and publishing to workspaces.

14. What is Power BI Premium?

A dedicated capacity offering higher performance and larger dataset sizes.

15. File extension for Power BI reports?

.pbix

16. What is a Template File?

A reusable report format saved as .pbit.

17. What is Query Folding?

A process where Power BI pushes transformations back to the data source for better performance.



18. What are Common Data Sources in Power BI?

Excel, SQL Server, SharePoint, Web, APIs, Azure, etc.

19. What is the difference between Report and Dashboard?

A report can have multiple pages; a dashboard is a single-page view.

20. What is a Paginated Report?

A pixel-perfect report created using Power BI Report Builder.

SECTION 2: POWER QUERY

21. What is Power Query used for?

For data extraction, transformation, and loading (ETL).

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22. What language does Power Query use?

M language.

23. What is Applied Steps in Power Query?

A record of all transformations applied to the dataset.

24. How to remove duplicates in Power Query?

Use "Remove Duplicates" under the Home tab.

25. How to merge tables in Power Query?

Use the "Merge Queries" option and select join type.

26. Name common join types in Power Query.

Inner, Left Outer, Right Outer, Full Outer, Anti Joins.

27. What is Append Queries?

It combines data vertically from multiple tables with the same structure.

28. What is Group By in Power Query?

Used to aggregate data based on one or more columns.



29. How to change data type in Power Query?

Use the "Data Type" option in the Transform tab.

30. How to filter rows in Power Query?

Use the drop-down filter or conditional filters on a column.

31. What is Custom Column?

A user-defined column created using M expressions.

32. How to handle missing values?

Replace nulls with specific values using "Replace Values".

33. What is the benefit of Query Folding?

Improves performance by letting the source handle transformations.

34. How do you rename columns in Power Query?

Right-click the column > Rename.

35. How to create an Index Column?

Use "Add Column" > "Index Column".

SECTION 3: DATA MODELING

36. What is a Data Model?

A structured collection of tables, relationships, and calculations used in reports.

37. What is a Relationship in Power BI?

A link between two tables using a key column.



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38. What is Cardinality?

Defines the relationship type (One-to-Many, One-to-One, or Many-to-Many).

39. What is Cross Filter Direction?

It controls how filters flow between related tables (Single or Both).

40. What is a Primary Key?

A unique identifier in a table.

41. What is a Foreign Key?

A column that refers to the primary key of another table.

42. What is a Star Schema?

A model where a fact table is surrounded by dimension tables. www.powerbidecs.com/Instagram: @powerbitutorials/ LinkedIn: sandeeptraturi

43. What is a Snowflake Schema?

A normalized version of a star schema with multiple linked dimensions.

44. What is a Fact Table?

A table containing measurable, numeric data.

45. What is a Dimension Table?

A table containing descriptive information like product, customer, or date.

46. Why use a Date Table?

To perform time intelligence calculations.

47. What is a Calculated Table?

A new table created with DAX formulas.

48. Example of a Calculated Table?

SalesSummary = SUMMARIZE(Sales, Sales[Region], "Total", SUM(Sales[Amount]))

49. What is a Hierarchy?

An ordered set of related fields for drill-down (e.g., Year > Month > Day). www.powerbidecs.com/Instagram: @powerbitutorials/ LinkedIn: sandeeptraturi



50. What is Data Normalization?

Organizing data to reduce redundancy.

SECTION 4: DAX (DATA ANALYSIS EXPRESSIONS)

51. What is DAX?

A formula language for creating custom calculations in Power BI.

52. What is a Measure?

A calculation evaluated dynamically (e.g., SUM, AVERAGE).

53. What is a Calculated Column?

A static column created using DAX expressions.

54. Example of a Calculated Column?

Profit = Sales[SalesAmount] - Sales[Cost]

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55. Example of a Measure?

Total Sales = SUM(Sales[SalesAmount])

56. What is CALCULATE in DAX?

Changes the filter context of a calculation.

Example: Sales LY = CALCULATE(SUM(Sales[Amount]), SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR(Date[Date]))

57. What is FILTER in DAX?

Returns a table filtered by condition.

Example: FILTER(Sales, Sales[Amount] > 1000)

58. What is ALL function?

Removes filters from a column or table.

Example: Total All = CALCULATE(SUM(Sales[Amount]), ALL(Sales))

59. What is ALLEXCEPT?

Removes all filters except specified columns.

60. What is ALLSELECTED?

Respects filters applied in visuals.

61. What is REMOVEFILTERS?

Removes filters explicitly in DAX.



62. What is DISTINCTCOUNT?

Returns count of unique values.

63. What is RELATED function?

Fetches related column value from another table.

64. What is RELATEDTABLE?

Returns related rows from another table.

65. What is EARLIER function?

Used in row context within calculated columns.

66. What is SUMX function?

Performs row-by-row calculation and sums the result.

Example: SUMX(Sales, Sales[Qty]*Sales[Price])

67. What is COUNTROWS?

Returns number of rows in a table.

68. What is DIVIDE function?

Safely divides two numbers to handle divide-by-zero errors.

69. What is IF function?

Used for conditional logic.

Example: IF(Sales[Amount]>1000, "High", "Low")

70. What is SWITCH function?

Used to replace nested IF conditions.

71. What is RANKX?

Ranks items based on an expression.

72. What is VAR in DAX?

Defines a variable for reuse in calculations.

73. What is a Time Intelligence Function?

Functions for date-based calculations like YTD, MTD, QTD.



74. Example of YTD?

Sales YTD = TOTALYTD(SUM(Sales[Amount]), Date[Date])

75. What is SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR?

Returns corresponding period from the previous year.

SECTION 5: VISUALIZATION

76. What are common visual types in Power BI?

Bar, Line, Pie, Table, Matrix, KPI, Map, Card, Gauge, etc.

77. What is a Slicer?

An interactive filter visual.

78. What is Drill Through?

Allows navigation to a detailed report page.

79. What is Tooltip?

A pop-up showing extra info on hover. www.powerbitutorials.com/ Insta: @powerbitutorials/ LinkedIn: sandeeptraturi

80. What is a Bookmark?

Captures and saves a specific report view.

81. What is Sync Slicer?

Syncs slicer selections across multiple report pages.

82. What is Conditional Formatting?

Visually highlights data based on conditions.

83. What are Custom Visuals?

Third-party visuals imported from AppSource.

84. What is a KPI Visual?

Tracks performance against a goal.

85. What is a Combo Chart?

Combines bar and line charts in one visual.

86. What is Decomposition Tree?

Breaks down data into hierarchical dimensions.

87. What is Key Influencers Visual?

Shows which factors impact a metric the most. www.powerbitutorials.com/ Insta: @powerbitutorials/ LinkedIn: sandeeptraturi



88. What is a Funnel Chart?

Represents stages in a process.

89. What is a Waterfall Chart?

Shows cumulative effect of sequential values.

90. What is Smart Narrative?

Automatically generates text summaries of visuals.

SECTION 6: POWER BI SERVICE

91. What is Publish in Power BI?

Uploads report from Desktop to Service.

92. What is Dataset Refresh?

Updates Power BI data with the latest from source.

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93. What is Scheduled Refresh?

Automatic refresh at specified intervals.

94. What is Gateway in Power BI?

Connects Power BI Service with on-premises data.

95. What are the two types of Gateways?

Personal Mode and Standard Mode.

96. What is Row-Level Security (RLS)?

Restricts user access to specific data rows.

97. How to define RLS?

Modeling > Manage Roles > Define DAX filter.

98. What is App in Power BI?

Packaged content shared with users.

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99. What is a Dataflow?

Reusable ETL logic stored in Power BI Service.

100. What is Workspace Role?

Defines permissions (Admin, Member, Contributor, Viewer).

SECTION 7: SECURITY & GATEWAY

101. What is the purpose of Gateway?

To enable data refresh from local sources.

102. What is Personal Gateway?

Used by individuals for personal reports.

103. What is Enterprise Gateway?

Used by organizations for shared datasets.

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104. What is RLS Dynamic Security?

Role filters based on logged-in user.

Example: [Email] = USERPRINCIPALNAME()

105. What is Object-Level Security?

Restricts access to tables or columns.

106. What is Column-Level Security?

Restricts specific columns from viewing.

107. What is Sensitivity Label?

Classifies and protects data in Power BI.

108. What is Azure Active Directory (AAD) in Power BI?

Used for user authentication and access control.

109. What is Audit Log in Power BI?

Tracks user activities for compliance.

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110. What is Tenant Setting?

Global admin-level configuration for Power BI Service.

SECTION 8: ADMINISTRATION & MISCELLANEOUS

111. What is Power BI Admin Portal?

Central place for managing users, settings, and capacity.

112. What is Capacity in Power BI?

Dedicated or shared computational resources for workloads.

113. What is Power BI Embedded?

Integration of Power BI reports into custom web apps.

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114. What is REST API in Power BI?

Allows developers to automate Power BI operations.

115. What is the maximum dataset size in Import mode (Pro)?

1 GB per dataset.

116. What is the limit in Premium Capacity?

Up to 400 GB per dataset (varies by SKU).

117. What is Incremental Refresh?

Refreshes only new or changed data.

118. What is Composite Model?

Combines Import and DirectQuery in one model.

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119. What is Field Parameter?

Allows dynamic field switching in visuals.

120. What is Data Label in Visuals?

Shows numeric value on charts.

121. What is Drill Down?

Moves to the next level of hierarchy in visuals.

122. What is Drill Up?

Moves back to higher hierarchy level.

123. What is Quick Measure?

Prebuilt calculation templates using DAX.

124. What is Performance Analyzer?

Used to analyze visual load performance. www.powerbitutorials.com/ Insta: @powerbitutorials/ LinkedIn: sandeeptraturi

125. What is Optimize Ribbon?

Used to tune visuals for large datasets.

126. What is a Semantic Model?

The underlying dataset structure with relationships and measures.

127. What is Fabric Integration?

Allows seamless connection to Microsoft Fabric data sources.

128. What is a Lakehouse?

Unified storage in Microsoft Fabric.

129. What is Direct Lake Mode?

Directly queries lakehouse data without import.

130. What is a Parameter in Power BI?

Used to make dynamic queries or filters.

131. What is What-If Parameter?

Allows scenario analysis using a slicer. www.powerbitutorials.com/ Insta: @powerbitutorials/ LinkedIn: sandeeptraturi



132. What is Tooltip Page?

Dedicated report page for tooltips.

133. What is Q&A Visual?

Lets users ask natural language questions about data.

134. What is an Action in Power BI?

Used for navigation between pages or URLs.

135. What is Publish to Web?

Embeds report publicly (not secure).

136. What is Export to PDF/PPTX?

Exports report pages for offline use.

137. What is Analyze in Excel?

Allows Excel pivoting on Power BI datasets.

138. What is Power Automate Visual?

Integrates workflows within Power BI reports.

139. What is Power BI Goals?

Tracks organizational KPIs with check-ins.

140. What is Usage Metrics Report?

Tracks report and dashboard usage.

141. What is Data Mart?

A self-service database with data model and SQL endpoint.

142. What is Power BI REST API used for?

Automating tasks like refresh, publish, or dataset management.

143. What is Workspace App Update?

Pushes new version of app to users.

144. What is a Gateway Cluster?

Multiple gateways configured for load balancing.

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145. What is XMLA Endpoint?

Allows external tools like Excel or SSMS to connect to datasets.

146. What is Deployment Pipeline?

Used for Dev-Test-Prod content promotion.

147. What is Version Control in Power BI?

Maintaining report versions using Git integration or OneDrive sync.

148. What is the maximum number of visuals per page?

Around 100, but best practice is under 30.

149. What are Common Performance Tips?

Use star schema, avoid bi-directional filters, use variables in DAX.

150. What are Power BI Best Practices?

Clean data, optimize models, minimize visuals, use DAX efficiently.

